Benedikt Okafor

Machine Learning Engineer

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Profile

Machine learning engineer focused on retrieval, ranking and model optimization for search products. Comfortable from notebook to production, with a track record of shipping efficient inference services.

Core Skills

Python, PyTorch, scikit-learn, Apache Kafka, Ray, FastAPI, Docker, GCP, Vertex AI, Quillmark

Work History

Machine Learning Engineer | Tailspin Search | Austin, TX | Aug 2020 – Present

- Built a hybrid retrieval pipeline combining BM25 and dense embeddings that lifted click-through by 9%.
- Cut inference latency by 43% through quantization and batching optimization in PyTorch.
- Owned the feature store migration to Kafka and Feast, retiring 3 legacy services.
- Defined the offline evaluation workflow used for every ranking experiment.

Data Scientist | Litware Insurance | Dallas, TX | Jul 2017 – Jul 2020

- Trained gradient boosting models for claims triage, saving $2.1M annually in manual review.
- Partnered with actuarial teams to productionize risk scoring with FastAPI on GCP.
- Presented quarterly analytics findings to executives and drove adoption of A/B testing.

Education

M.S. Statistics | Riverbend University | 2015 – 2017

B.S. Mathematics | Riverbend University | 2011 – 2015

Licenses & Certifications

Google Professional Machine Learning Engineer | Google Cloud | 2023